



November 2025

Policy Decision 25-02

Testing arrangements and cost sharing of diagnostic testing expenses during an emergency animal disease response

Animal Health Committee

Purpose

This policy has been developed to clarify arrangements in an emergency animal disease (EAD) response for:

- diagnostic testing of samples relating to the outbreak,
- invoicing procedures for samples submitted to the Australian Centre for Disease Preparedness (ACDP), and
- eligibility of diagnostic testing expenses incurred by infected and non-infected jurisdictions for cost-sharing.

Scope

This policy applies to samples submitted under an approved Emergency Animal Disease Response Plan (EADRP).

Exclusion testing by ACDP

ACDP does not charge jurisdictions for the costs of initial testing of samples from the first suspected premises to confirm or exclude an EAD outbreak. This testing is funded by ACDP as part of their normal commitments.

EAD surveillance plans

When an EAD outbreak has been confirmed, infected jurisdictions develop surveillance plans that set out what samples will be collected and submitted for laboratory testing.

Non-infected jurisdictions that anticipate having to conduct additional surveillance for the EAD above routine exclusion testing / normal commitments may also develop surveillance plans for the EAD. If there is more than one non-infected jurisdiction performing additional surveillance, the development of a national surveillance plan, led by the Australian Government Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry, is preferred.

Cost sharing of testing done in an EAD response

An infected or non-infected jurisdiction that wishes to cost share expenses incurred for testing (by ACDP or jurisdictional laboratories etc.) of EAD samples during an EAD outbreak must submit an emergency animal disease response plan (EADRP) that details their proposed surveillance strategy

and associated budget to the Consultative Committee on Emergency Animal Diseases (CCEAD) and National Management Group (NMG).

Costs incurred by a jurisdiction for activities conducted as part of an approved EADRP are eligible for cost sharing.

Testing of samples at ACDP during an EAD response

The following samples collected as part of an approved EADRP may be submitted by the infected or non-infected jurisdiction to ACDP for testing:

- Any sample for which the jurisdictional laboratory does not have the capability or capacity to conduct definitive testing (using tests for which the laboratory has been validated under the LEADDR network).
- Any sample that has tested positive at a jurisdictional laboratory.
- Any sample where an inconclusive test result cannot be resolved by further testing at the jurisdictional laboratory.

Charging for testing conducted by ACDP in an EAD response

ACDP will:

- charge jurisdictions for testing of all response surveillance samples relating to the EAD response collected post the initial investigation to confirm the EAD.
- continue to charge for testing of response surveillance samples until the NMG declare that cost sharing of the response has ceased (e.g. the outbreak has been eradicated, a transition to management program has been completed or the cost shared response ceases).
- not charge jurisdictions for any exclusion testing for other EADs, including such testing on samples collected for response surveillance.
- also charge an additional fee for any staff overtime and other emergency management costs related to testing of EAD samples submitted as part of surveillance for an EAD response.
- advise all CVOs of the rate to be charged for each test during the EAD response.
- issue a monthly invoice to each jurisdiction who has submitted surveillance samples for the response. The invoice will detail the type of testing conducted, and the number and cost of each test conducted.

The CVO or delegate of each jurisdiction will advise the ACDP of the email address/es to which invoices for EAD response testing costs are to be sent.

Messaging should be simple and in language appropriate to meet stakeholder communication needs.

References

- 1) AHC48_OOS29_RESOLUTION_Testing arrangements and cost-sharing of laboratory costs during an EAD response.

More information

Learn more about the [Animal Health Committee](#).

Email ahc@agriculture.gov.au

Acknowledgement of Country

We acknowledge the Traditional Custodians of Australia and their continuing connection to land and sea, waters, environment and community. We pay our respects to the Traditional Custodians of the lands we live and work on, their culture, and their Elders past and present.

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